

9.1.3 Configuration

At this point in the book, I've written *settings.py* 39 times. Django is very configurable, and all that happens in your *settings.py* file (40). If you're trying to understand how your system is configured, it can be useful to see the difference between your current settings and the defaults. The *diffsettings* management command does just that:

```
(venv) RiffMates$ python manage.py diffsettings
DEBUG = True
DEFAULT_AUTO_FIELD = 'django.db.models.BigAutoField'
EMAIL_BACKEND = 'django.core.mail.backends.console.EmailBackend'
INSTALLED_APPS = ['django.contrib.admin', 'django.contrib.auth',
                  'django.contrib.contenttypes', 'django.contrib.sessions',
                  'django.contrib.messages', 'django.contrib.staticfiles', 'home',
                  'bands', 'content']
LOGIN_REDIRECT_URL = '/'
LOGOUT_REDIRECT_URL = '/'
ROOT_URLCONF = 'RiffMates.urls' ###
```

This output is truncated; the full list can be quite long. In chapter 6 you added `LOGIN_REDIRECT_URL`, `LOGOUT_REDIRECT_URL`, and `EMAIL_BACKEND` to *settings.py*, so it might not be a surprise to see them. A little less obvious is `DEFAULT_AUTO_FIELD`. Although you haven't set it yourself, the skeleton *settings.py* file created by the *createproject* command sets this value. It shows up in the output because it is different from the default, even if that difference got created by Django.

Likewise, for the `INSTALLED_APPS` value; it shows here that you've added your own apps, but even if you hadn't, the various django apps included by *createproject* aren't in the underlying default configuration. This is where *diffsettings* can get a little noisy, even things you haven't changed yourself might not match the base configuration. This means you have to go wading through some values set by *createproject* to see what you actually changed.

Note the `###` on the end of the `ROOT_URLCONF` value; this is how *diffsettings* indicates a value that has no default. Your project won't work without a `ROOT_URLCONF`, but there is no default. Any custom values you add yourself will also appear with the `###` suffix. If you'd like to see all the default configuration values, the *global_settings.py* file in the Django source code is the place to look: <http://mng.bz/yZn7>.

9.1.4 Flushing the database

One of the many wonderful experiences in writing a book is learning something new yourself. Until playing around with a few management commands to write this chapter, I wasn't aware that *flush* even existed. This command wipes your database, except without resetting your migrations. Obviously, this is a drastic move, but when you're developing a new project that hasn't gone into production yet, you likely have a bunch of sample data kicking around from your manual testing. Using the *flush* command clears all database tables, keeping the structure and migration state. As you might hope, it asks if you're sure: